

Anway Pimpalkar

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EDUCATION

Harvard University PhD, Mechanical Engineering Advisors: Katia Bertoldi, PhD (Harvard) and Giovanni Traverso, PhD (MIT)	2025 – Present
Johns Hopkins University MSE, Biomedical Engineering Thesis: Bridging Perception & Performance: Generating, Calibrating, & Evaluating Multimodal Sensory Feedback Advisor: Jeremy D. Brown, PhD	2023 – 2025
College of Engineering Pune, India BTech, Electronics and Telecommunication Engineering	2019 – 2023

AWARDS & HONORS

Harvard SEAS Prize Fellowship (\$281,796 • 6-yr tuition, 2-yr stipend) • Harvard University	2025 – 2031
National Defense Science & Engineering Graduate Fellowship (\$277,484) • US DOD	2025 – 2028
GEM Associate Fellowship • National GEM Consortium	2025 – 2031
Best Student Paper Finalist [for C2] • International Conference on Rehabilitation Robotics (ICORR)	2025
Start-Up Challenge Finalist (\$10,000) • National Institute on Aging of the NIH	2025
Best Paper Award [for C1] • International Conference on Biomedical Engineering Science and Tech.	2023
Mitacs Globalink Research Award (\$9,915) • Dalhousie University, Canada	2022
Best Project Award [for O1] • IEEE National Project Competition, India	2021

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE abbreviated; details at the end of CV

Harvard University • <i>Bertoldi Solid Mechanics Group</i> ↗	Cambridge, MA
Massachusetts Institute of Technology • <i>Laboratory for Translational Engineering</i> ↗ Doctoral Research Fellow • Co-advisors: Katia Bertoldi, PhD and Giovanni Traverso, PhD	Oct 2025 –
- Bistable Mechanisms for Ingestible and Interactive Devices - Ingestible Devices for Stress Management	
Johns Hopkins University • <i>Haptics and Medical Robotics Lab</i> ↗	Baltimore, MD
Graduate Research Assistant • Advisor: Jeremy D. Brown, PhD	Jan 2024 – Jun 2025
- Multimodal Visual-Haptic Neurorehabilitation for Post-Stroke Finger Dexterity - Pneumatactors: Soft Multimodal Haptic Interfaces	
Harvard University • <i>Biohybrid Organs and Neuroprosthetics Lab</i> ↗	Cambridge, MA
Research Fellow • Advisor: Shriya S. Srinivasan, PhD	May – Aug 2024
- Peripheral Nerve Stimulation to Modulate Cancer Tumor Metastasis - Surgical Approach for Treating Stress Urinary Incontinence	
IIT Bombay • <i>Human Motor Neurophysiology and Neuromodulation Lab</i> ↗	Mumbai, India
Research Intern • Advisor: Nivethida Thirugnanasambandam, PhD	Jan – Aug 2023
Quantifying Prospective Component of Sense of Agency using Machine Learning	
College of Engineering Pune • <i>Department of Applied Sciences</i> ↗	Pune, India
Undergraduate Researcher • Advisor: Mahesh H. Shindikar, PhD	Aug 2022 – Aug 2023

- Deep Learning-Based MRI Skull Tissue Segmentation

Dalhousie University • *Agricultural Mechanized Systems Group* [↗](#)

Truro, Canada

Mitacs Globalink Research Intern • Advisor: Travis J. Esau, PhD

May – Aug 2022

- Automating Harvesters to Reduce Operator Cognitive Load

Queliz Lifetech • *Early Stage Medtech Startup* [↗](#)

Pune, India

Research Intern, Electronics Subsystem

Jun – Sep 2021

- Point-of-Care Device for Finger Dexterity Rehabilitation in Acute Burn Patients

JOURNAL PUBLICATIONS

- J4 **Pimpalkar A**, Brown JD. *Pneumatactors: Soft 3D-printed interface for co-located transient and continuous tactile stimuli*. In preparation. 2026.
- J3 **Pimpalkar A**, West AM, Rai D, Xu J, Brown JD. *Evaluation of multimodal feedback to augment motor control in precision grip*. In preparation. 2026.
- J2 Harris C, **Pimpalkar A**, Aggarwal A, Yang J, Chen X, Schmidgall S, Rapuri S, Greenstein JL, Taylor CO, Stevens RD. *Preoperative risk prediction of major cardiovascular events in noncardiac surgery using the 12-lead electrocardiogram: explainable deep learning approach*. Br J Anaesth; 2025 Sep; doi: 10.1016/j.bja.2025.07.085 [↗](#)
Featured in *The Hub at Johns Hopkins*. [Article](#) [↗](#)
- J1 **Pimpalkar A**, Slepian A, Thakor NV. *Vibrations at first contact encode object stiffness before grasp completion*. IEEE Sens Lett. 2025 Aug;9(8):1–4. doi: 10.1109/lensens.2025.3584860 [↗](#)
Featured in *New Scientist Magazine*. [Article](#) [↗](#)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS [†](#) presenter

FULL-LENGTH PAPERS

- C4 West AM, Kasimcan B, **Pimpalkar A**, Xu J, Brown JD. *Cross-modal matching is not bidirectional: Implications for human multisensory feedback*. In review at 2026 IEEE RAS EMBS Int Conf Biomed Robot Biomechatron.
- C3 West AM [†](#), **Pimpalkar A**, Xu J, Brown JD. *SenseMatch: Smartphone-based cross-modal matching for accessible perceptual assessments*. 2025 Int IEEE EMBS Conf Neural Eng (NER), 2025 Nov. In print. [Spotlight Poster]
- C2 **Pimpalkar A** [†](#), West AM, Xu J, Brown JD. *Optimizing cross-modal matching for multimodal motor rehabilitation*. 2025 IEEE Int Conf Rehabil Robot (ICORR). 2025 May. p. 559–566. doi: 10.1109/icorr66766.2025.11063112 [↗](#) [Podium Pres] [Best Student Paper Award Finalist](#).
- C1 **Pimpalkar A** [†](#), Patole RK, Kamble KD, Shindikar MH. *Performance evaluation of vanilla, residual, and dense 2D U-Net architectures for skull stripping of augmented 3D T1-weighted MRI head scans*. 2023 Int Conf Biomed Eng Sci Tech. 2023 Feb. p. 131–142. doi: 10.1007/978-3-031-54547-4_11 [↗](#) [Podium Pres] [Best Paper Award](#).

ABSTRACTS AND SHORT PAPERS

- A8 West AM, Kasimcan B, **Pimpalkar A**, Xu J, Brown JD. *Cross-modal matching is not bidirectionally invertible: Implications for multisensory representation*. 2026 Neural Control of Movement Meet. 2026 Apr. [Poster Pres]
- A7 **Pimpalkar A** [†](#), Rai D, Bartels UJ, Xu J, Brown JD. *Visual-haptic feedback enhances finger individuation in a virtual precision grip neurotraining task*. 2024 Biomed Eng Soc Ann Meet (BMES). 2024 Oct. [Podium Pres, [Abs](#) [↗](#)]
- A6 Song H [†](#) et al. [including **Pimpalkar A**]. *Towards visual function restoration through photoacoustic stimulation*. Invest Ophthalmol Vis Sci. 2024 Jun. [Podium Pres, [Abs](#) [↗](#)]
- A5 **Pimpalkar A** [†](#), Ameta P [†](#), Dalia A, Brown JD. *Pneumatactor arrays for high frequency vibrotactile feedback*. 2024 IEEE Haptics Symp. 2024 Apr. [Live Demo, Work-in-Prog Paper]
- A4 **Pimpalkar A** [†](#), Ameta P [†](#), Dalia A [†](#), Brown JD. *Pneumatactor arrays for high frequency vibrotactile feedback*. 2024 US Senate AI Cauc Robotics Demo Day. 2024 Apr. [Live Demo]
- A3 Harris C [†](#), **Pimpalkar A**, Aggarwal A, Yang P, Chen X, Taylor CO, Greenstein J, Stevens RD. *Surgical risk prediction using an explainable deep learning approach applied to pre-operative 12-lead electrocardiograms*. 2024 JH Med & Eng Res Retr. 2024 Feb. [Poster Pres]

- A2 **Pimpalkar A** †, Patole R, Thirugnanasambandam N. *Demonstrating the prospective component of sense of agency using machine learning*. 2023 COEP ENTIC BTEch Proj Symp. 2023 May. [Poster Pres]
- A1 **Pimpalkar A** †, Patole R, Kamble K, Shindikar M. *Evaluating U-Nets for skull stripping of augmented T1-weighted MRI scans*. 2023 No Garland Neurosci Conf. 2023 Feb. [Podium Pres]

NON PEER-REVIEWED ARTICLES

- O1 **Pimpalkar A**, Niture D. *Towards contactless elevators with tinyML using person detection and keyword spotting*. 2024 Jul. **Best Project Award**. doi: arXiv:2405.13051 [↗](#)

TEACHING ENGAGEMENTS

Principles of the Design of Biomedical Instrumentation • Johns Hopkins University 580.771 Fall 2024

Teaching Assistant to Nitish V. Thakor, PhD

- Mentored labs on designing ECG, EMG, EEG circuits and projects including accessible gaming, wearables.

Haptic Interface Design for Human-Robot Interaction • Johns Hopkins University 530.691 Fall 2024

Class Researcher with Jeremy D. Brown, PhD

- Helped implement an online learning platform providing self-paced lectures incorporating live instructor interaction.

Mechatronics • Johns Hopkins University 530.421

Spring 2024

Teaching Assistant to Jeremy D. Brown, PhD

- Solved a 3-year challenge in real-time location polling of autonomous air hockey robots using CV-based ArUco tag detection and ZigBee mesh networking. Led labs on building autonomous robots. [GitHub ↗](#)

INVITED LECTURES

- T1 Neural & Rehabilitation Engineering Course, Johns Hopkins University. (Nitish V. Thakor, PhD) [*Haptics: Neural Basis, Applications, Future Avenues*], Sep 2024.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

IEEE Haptics Symposium • Student Volunteer 2024

Canadian Society of Bioengineering Annual Meeting • Student Volunteer 2022

LEADERSHIP AND TEAMWORK

Johns Hopkins India Institute • Operations Team 2024 – 2025

- Managed on-day operations and logistics for the first annual Hopkins-India Conference.

Johns Hopkins Biomedical Engineering • Master's Program Representative 2024 – 2025

COEP Impressions Cultural Festival • Head of Events (2021), Volunteer 2019 – 2021

- Led the planning and execution of 28 annual events with 10k attendees, managing a ₹2m budget and coordinating with an overall team of 126 members to execute concerts, competitions, and international celebrity engagements.
- Built and led a team of 15, working with 2 co-heads to build a platform from the ground up, fostering opportunities for budding artists across India and uniting them under a shared vision.

Rowing Team • COEP, Pune City • Competitive 1X, 2X, 4X Sculler 2020 – 2022

- Won multiple race events and an institutional award. Represented city at regional races.

COEP Mental Health & Wellness Center • Student Volunteer 2020 – 2022

COEP Data Science & AI Club • Research Lead (2020-21), Member 2020 – 2022

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE detailed

Massachusetts Institute of Technology • *Laboratory for Translational Engineering* [↗](#) Cambridge, MA

Harvard University • *Bertoldi Group* [↗](#)

Doctoral Research Fellow • Advisors: Giovanni Traverso, PhD and Katia Bertoldi, PhD

Sep 2025 –

Bistable Mechanisms for Ingestible and Interactive Devices

Ingestible Devices for Stress Management

Johns Hopkins University • *Haptics and Medical Robotics Lab* [↗](#)

Baltimore, MD

Graduate Research Assistant • Advisor: Jeremy D. Brown, PhD

Jan 2024 – Jun 2025

Multimodal Visual-Haptic Neurorehabilitation for Post-Stroke Finger Dexterity

- Developed and evaluated a multimodal feedback framework for motor rehabilitation.
- Integrated cross-modal perceptual calibration to optimize sensory feedback delivery to individual thresholds.
- Implemented on ubiquitous devices to support smartphone-based rehabilitation outside the lab.
- *Publications:* [J3](#), [C2](#) (Best Student Paper Finalist at ICORR 2025), [C3](#), [C4](#), [A7](#), [A8](#)

Pneumatactors: Soft Multimodal Haptic Interfaces

- Engineered “*pneumatactors*” – a novel pneumatic tactor haptic interface designed for co-located stimulation of fast and slow adapting mechanoreceptors, enhancing cognitive salience. 3D-printed with flexible TPE to match mechanical impedance of human skin for intuitive interaction.
- *Publications:* [J4](#), [A4](#), [A5](#)

Harvard University • *Biohybrid Organs and Neuroprosthetics Lab* [↗](#)

Cambridge, MA

Research Fellow • Advisor: Shriya S. Srinivasan, PhD

May – Aug 2024

Peripheral Nerve Stimulation to Modulate Cancer Tumor Metastasis

- Developed non-invasive peripheral nerve stimulation strategies to modulate tumor growth and metastasis in murine models, revealing frequency-dependent effects on tumor innervation. Designed and conducted pilot studies on melanoma-bearing mice.
- Engineered miniaturized, RF-powered vagus nerve stimulators for freely moving rodents to study glioblastoma and nervous system interactions. Devices delivered monophasic pulses up to 1 kHz via custom PCB oscillators, enabling targeted parasympathetic modulation in vivo.

Surgical Approach for Treating Stress Urinary Incontinence

- Innovated and tested a fully endogenous muscle graft-based surgical technique for treating stress urinary incontinence, featuring a 30-minute procedure with potential for fully laparoscopic implementation and superior efficacy compared to urethral devices.
- Conducted pilot surgeries on rat models, synchronizing bladder pressure, flow, and tension using a custom-designed PCB to assess and analyze urodynamic parameters.

IIT Bombay • *Human Motor Neurophysiology and Neuromodulation Lab* [↗](#)

Mumbai, India

Research Intern • Advisor: Nivethida Thirugnanasambandam, PhD

Jan – Aug 2023

Quantifying Prospective Component of Sense of Agency using Machine Learning

- Characterized pre-movement EEG signatures underlying the Sense of Agency using a modified Libet clock task with probabilistic auditory feedback. Applied spectral, time-series, and machine learning analyses to identify spatiotemporal patterns predictive of intentional binding.
- Demonstrated distinct neural correlates in pre-SMA and centroparietal regions, supporting a prospective model of agency.
- *Publications:* [A2](#), Bachelor's Dissertation

College of Engineering Pune • *Department of Applied Sciences* [↗](#)

Pune, India

Undergraduate Researcher • Advisor: Mahesh H. Shindikar, PhD

Aug 2022 – Aug 2023

Deep Learning-Based MRI Skull Tissue Segmentation

- Developed and benchmarked vanilla, residual, and dense 2D U-Net architectures for skull stripping in neuroimaging, achieving 99.75% accuracy with a dense model optimized for feature reuse. Implemented data

augmentation to improve generalizability across multi-scanner datasets. Demonstrated utility of open deep learning pipelines for replacing proprietary tools in MRI workflows.

- *Publications:* [C1](#) (Best Paper Award at ICBEST 2023), [A1](#)

Dalhousie University • *Agricultural Mechanized Systems Group* [↗](#)

Truro, Canada

Mitacs Globalink Research Intern • Advisor: Travis J. Esau, PhD

May – Aug 2022

Automating Harvesters to Reduce Operator Cognitive Load

- Engineered a closed-loop control system to automate bin switching and dynamic harvester head height adjustment, reducing operator load. Used RGBD sensing for volumetric bin fill estimation ($\pm 10\%$ accuracy), and integrated crop height and GPS data to actuate harvester head in real time.

Queliz Lifetech • *Early Stage Medtech Startup* [↗](#)

Pune, India

Research Intern, Electronics Subsystem

Jun – Sep 2021

Point-of-Care Device for Finger Dexterity Rehabilitation in Acute Burn Patients

- Designed an affordable, portable rehabilitation device to restore MCP, DIP, and PIP joint mobility in burn patients. Developed a precision actuation system with adaptive feedback to enable customized therapy in low-resource clinical settings.